self-help group.[100] Similarly, women accounted for 53 per cent of banking accounts (20.33 crore of 38.13 crore) opened under the PMJDY.[101] This large representation of women in Jan Dhan accounts (launched in 2014) is particularly important. Having these accounts (they require no minimum balance) is a prerequisite for eligibility to the government's social security schemes on life insurance of ₹30,000, accident insurance of ₹2 lakh, overdraft of up to ₹10,000 and Mudra loans.[102] Moreover, Jan Dhan accounts are the conduit for direct-benefit cash transfers under a host of government schemes.

Of the 17.1 million rural houses sanctioned under the PMAY-G, those registered in women's names or in joint ownership with their husbands accounted for as much as 66.9 per cent by October 2020.[103] This was the result of a 2016 decision by the Modi government to prioritise the commissioning of houses built in the name of a woman or jointly with her husband. In urban areas, registration of houses in women's names was made mandatory in 2016. This was done, Modi explained, so that women 'get security'.[104] The impact of this is revolutionary in a country where daughters have long been denied legal inheritance. Hindu women only got the legal right to inherit parental property in the same way as male heirs and their families in 2005 through an amendment of the Hindu Succession Act of 1956. This legal right was further expanded to women whose fathers had died before 2005 by a landmark Supreme Court judgement on 11 August 2020.[105] In a milieu in which women had faced so many barriers to equality in property rights, the fact that as many as 4.54 million rural houses built under PM Awaas Yojana-Gramin were registered in the names of women and another 6.9 million were registered jointly in the names of wives and husbands is truly significant. Put another way, of the 17.1 million houses sanctioned under this scheme, only 5.6 million were registered in the names of men alone, and 11.4 million women had new residential property registered in their names (as single or joint owners).[106] Interestingly, a very large proportion of these women-registered houses—as many as 5.02 million—were built in Hindi heartland states, where patriarchal norms have